MONTHLY UPDATE

Training and skills: monthly update, September – October 2026

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> *33 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · BENIN · BURKINA FASO · CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · COTE D'IVOIRE · DJIBOUTI · EGYPT · ESWATINI · GABON · GAMBIA · GHANA · GUINEA · KENYA · LESOTHO · LIBERIA · LIBYA · MALI · MAURITANIA · MOROCCO · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SENEGAL · SIERRA LEONE · SOUTH AFRICA · SOUTH SUDAN · SUDAN · TANZANIA · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

On 10 September the higher education and scientific research minister directed the five higher schools specialising in economics, finance and management to modernise their training and embed artificial intelligence, at a working meeting at the Kolea hub, in a statement on his own social-media account. No curriculum, timetable, teaching capacity, funding or implementing circular is published, and the five schools are not named.

Angola

The telecommunications institute and a cable operator signed a cooperation protocol on 3 September at the technology innovation fair, under which the operator offers internships to students and supplies internet service to the institute.

Benin

UNICEF handed the secondary education ministry 628 items of computer equipment on 11 September, for 43 schools in nine departments, enough for 12 new digital classrooms beside the 55 already deployed.

Burkina Faso

On 24 September the digital ministry opened a two-day artificial-intelligence course for the secretaries general of all ministries and institutions, covering generative tools and which administrative data may be put into them; no instrument governing AI use in ministries has followed on the record.

An association of blind and partially sighted students closed its fifth adapted computing course on 11 September, having trained 70 visually impaired pupils and students from first computer use to e-mail and AI, and its president said they have no computers to practise on afterwards.

Central African Republic

The government signed a five-year partnership with Russia on 9 October 2026, implemented through HSE University, for digital-governance training of public servants, joint research and expert seminars.

Cote d'Ivoire

The technical education ministry and UNESCO launched a project on 17 September to train some 3,000 technical and vocational teachers and heads in the teaching use of AI by 2027, piloted in Abidjan with 1,907 enrolled at launch against 1,000 planned.

Djibouti

Two cohorts finished. Ten children aged 9 to 16 completed seven weeks of coding, robotics and artificial intelligence at the national technology and innovation centre on 5 September, and Djibouti Telecom certified 35 of its engineers in artificial intelligence on 17 September. Neither account gives a cost. The Francophonie organisation and the education ministry signed an agreement to train 200 young people in development, networks and cybersecurity.

Egypt

The national telecommunication institute signed a memorandum with Cisco to certify 3,000 technology instructors, 1,000 a year for three years (2 September), and protocols on AI capacity building with a state authority, enterprise-systems training with a private firm and digital transformation and automation with another. None publishes a cohort size, cost or placement target.

The presidential Digilians initiative admitted 1,674 of about 40,000 applicants to its first cohort, the state paying EGP 500,000 to EGP 1m per trainee for master's and diploma tracks in AI, data science, software and cybersecurity, on ministry figures; no completion figure is published. The communications and labour ministries signed a memorandum to digitise the labour ministry's work and run digital-skills programmes for its staff, graduates and job seekers.

Eswatini

In schools, the education minister set out more than 1,140 computers donated by Taiwan to 49 schools and 40 interactive screens installed in five schools per region, with 106 more schools to follow, and a US$4.75 million Global Partnership grant whose terms were not given.

The civil service is being prepared for the Digital Eswatini Project's implementation phase. On 24 September about 40 change agents from five ministries and participating parastatals, organised as a change-agent network since their first training, assessed the readiness of their own directorates; no count of the staff they cover is published.

Gabon

The primary-school digitalisation programme entered its scale-up phase, the pilot having grown from nine schools to 69, as teacher training opened at Mouila on 25 September; the coordinator put satellite-connected schools at more than 120, below the operator's own count.

Gambia

The national university's technology school offers three bachelor's degrees and six-month diplomas in artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and data science, the widest named provision the repository holds.

The employment ministry signed memoranda with the applied science university, the Civil Service University and a hardware-technology institute to deliver three years of digital labour skills training under the regional digital integration programme, aimed at youth, women and persons with disabilities; no budget or participant figure is stated.

Ghana

The ministry said on 7 September that it had signed memoranda with eleven universities to embed digital certifications into degree and diploma programmes, naming five of them and leaving six, the certifications, the start date and any student number unstated.

The coders programme published its funnel rather than a headline for the first time: 141,954 registered accounts, 27,782 admitted learners and 5,812 logged course completions as at 2 August 2026, cybersecurity the largest track at 8,570, with 30,444 admitted through one commercial platform, 10,143 through a second and 24,394 learners self-paced. Registration is not admission and admission is not completion, and it is the ratio between them rather than any one number that measures the programme against its target of a million.

The coders programme is to reach first-year degrees: the minister said 12 universities have signed memoranda to carry its courses in Level 100.

The TVET Service signed a memorandum with UNESCO, KPMG and Microsoft under the AI EmpowerED initiative to train at least 100,000 TVET facilitators in AI and digital skills, reported on 23 September. No cost or timeline is stated.

Two school-level commitments were announced without money. The education ministry said it would open dialogue on a policy to scale a community ICT laboratory model nationwide, and Ghana signed an agreement with Intel to bring AI education into K-12 classrooms in New York; neither states a cost, a timeline or a school count. The Korean ambassador said the Korean aid agency is launching a US$28m digital basic education programme for 2026 to 2032.

Guinea

The state digitalisation agency put the feasibility study for a national digital academy to a validation workshop on 23 September: a permanent body adding short certified courses in information systems, artificial intelligence and cybersecurity to what the universities offer, aimed first at civil servants and supported by the World Bank-financed regional digital programme. No launch date or budget is stated. An operator's foundation and UNICEF signed a protocol on 5 October to equip 50 schools in six regions with connected learning hubs and train 500 adolescents; no budget or delivery date is stated.

Kenya

A mathematics and science teacher-training centre ran an international workshop for 100 teachers on 3 and 4 September on digital literacy for competency-based science teaching, its acting chief executive warning against dependence on artificial intelligence in classrooms. No guidance document, cascade plan or teacher-reach target is published behind it.

The largest vocational digitalisation project, some EUR 50m co-financed by KfW, the French development agency and the EU, opened prequalification for its implementation consultant on 22 September, with five years of delivery counted from that consultant's start. A privately run data-centre certification academy launched in Nairobi with a first cohort of five.

Lesotho

Government said efforts are under way to establish the Smart Africa Digital Academy in the country, with no host institution, budget or opening date stated.

Liberia

A second route into the national university was signed rather than built: a tripartite memorandum of 27 August under which a foreign online university covers 97% of online tuition for more than 200 students, with three smart classrooms due in 2027. No commitment amount is stated. National stakeholder consultations on establishing the university's master's programme in artificial intelligence are running with UNDP support, bringing together government institutions, development partners, academia, private-sector actors and civil society.

The gender ministry signed an agreement with Cybastion to build women's technology and business hubs with childcare centres, a flagship campus in Monrovia and sites in Voinjama, Gbarnga, Kakata and Buchanan, with training through the Cisco Networking Academy. It was signed in New York on 22 September for a 36-month term, with no cost stated.

Outside government, a foundation-backed computer and robotics laboratory in Monrovia, open since July 2024, reached 1,717 high-school students in 2025, up from about 200 in 2024, on the partner foundation's own figures.

Libya

The social affairs ministry and the minister of state for digital economy and artificial intelligence signed a memorandum launching the Wasl initiative at the Libya AI Forum in Tripoli on 10 October 2026, with one track on digital and artificial-intelligence skills for social-affairs staff and another on the digital empowerment of persons with disabilities.

Mali

The youth digital skills convention delivered its first cohort of 1,000, in bursaried four-month training toward a target of 15,000 over three years.

Mauritania

The education ministry opened a ten-day course on 8 September 2026 for 20 secondary education inspectors in documentation, archiving and electronic document management.

Morocco

The Génération AIoT programme opened seven cohorts in Casablanca, Fès and Oujda, aiming at 1,200 trained people a year from February 2027. Launched in February by the digital transition ministry with a foundation and a technology firm, it had drawn 2,118 applications and gathered 95 participants. No completion or placement figure is published.

The administration school and the digital development agency agreed on 22 September to train civil servants in digital transformation, AI and data management; no number of officials or start date was announced. The security directorate and the World Bank opened an executive cybersecurity programme in Rabat for leaders of African cybersecurity authorities.

Niger

Algeria's state operator signed a convention in Niamey on 8 September 2026 covering telecommunications infrastructure capacity and training, following a July accord aimed at a digital competence centre; its delegation visited the national telecommunications college on 9 September.

Nigeria

The federal training academy launched on 14 September with more than N10.5bn committed for over 32,000 trainees. Free digital and employability training opened for 50,000 young people in the North-Central states and the federal capital, towards a national target of 300,000. The regulator said its training institute has been designated an ITU Digital Transformation Centre.

Rwanda

A first cohort of 24 teachers completed a ten-day training-of-trainers programme to introduce cybersecurity courses in technical and vocational schools, reported on 9 September.

Senegal

A national digital training plan for state employees was validated at a workshop on 10 September 2026, setting role-graded competences in digital tools, data, AI and cybersecurity.

Sierra Leone

A first cohort of the civil service digital skills programme was in training in September and due to conclude on 25 September, with 1,000 civil servants planned in year one.

South Africa

Employers report about 55% of workers showing little or no proficiency in mathematics or data skills, 55% saying their workforce has only basic digital literacy, 52% finding it difficult to hire anyone prepared for digital transformation and 70% rating workforce technology skills poor or very poor, against 118,500 unfilled ICT vacancies, 36% of them junior roles; the country is ranked second in the world on education spending and 67th on digital skills. The figures come from an industry opinion piece citing a university survey and a non-profit's vacancy count.

South Sudan

A mobile operator opened an ICT hub at Rumbek, Lakes State, on 8 September 2026 with the state government. A state branch of the journalists' union trained more than 20 civil society, security and media representatives at Yei River County on cybercrime, the Computer Misuse Act 2026 and electoral preparedness.

Sudan

The higher education council's president approved by decision 138 of 2026 a regulation giving e-learning and blended learning in higher-education institutions a legal basis, in force from signature on 12 September.

Tanzania

The instrument behind teacher training entered the repository, and it is eleven years old. Delivery against the revision moved in the window — government secondary school teachers took a four-day programme in Arusha from 1 to 4 September covering 10 of the revised standards' 15 modules, under a third phase funded through a Korean funds-in-trust arrangement — which is the first time the repository can see modules being delivered rather than a training count. Fifteen modules against the held text's six is the gap the unpublished revision would close, and no teacher-reach figure is published against the target the digital economy framework carries.

Togo

The University of Lome's programme catalogue lists licences in software engineering, systems and networks, computing, and artificial intelligence and big data, masters in the last two, and a doctorate in computing. It carries no enrolment or graduate figure and names no cybersecurity degree.

The first artificial-intelligence summer school finished, training 100 young people in artificial intelligence and big data through the government data laboratory with German technical-cooperation support. The figure matches the hundred places announced; no selection ratio or destination for the cohort is published. The data-protection authority and the Universite de Kara signed a convention for a professional master's in digital law, cybersecurity and data protection. The correspondents scheme reached the state: thirty-three ministries and public institutions were briefed on naming focal points and certified data-protection correspondents, after thirty-two were certified from the private and parastatal sectors. No deadline or count of appointments made is published.

Tunisia

The first of twelve artificial-intelligence laboratories planned for vocational training centres in 2026-2027 was set up at the Kef centre, in partnership with the state operator, announced by the minister on 17 September. An annual analyst study carries the Order of Engineers' count: more than 7,000 engineers left in 2025, more than 8,000 are expected to leave in 2026, and 46,000 have gone in ten years against 105,000 on the Order's register. The repository holds no figure from the Order itself.

Uganda

The same operator handed over the second of four university innovation hubs under a Shs4 billion three-year programme at Busitema.

Zimbabwe

The youth ministry, UNDP and a training firm opened a solar-powered digital and AI hub with satellite connectivity at the Nyamuroro vocational training centre in Gokwe, enrolling 50 young people in a free one-year bootcamp from September and targeting 3,000 school learners and 300 teachers. No budget has been published.

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